

RULE BOOK
DATA VORTEX
Round 1

Event Overview:

- **Theme:** Rebuilding the Social Engine
- **Event Venue:** Online & Offline
- **Dates:** 13th September 2026 - 16th September 2026
- **Reporting Date:**
 - Inaugural Ceremony - 13th September 2026
- **Participation Type:** Individual as well as team(1-2 members)

Event Description

The Social Engine has suffered a critical failure, corrupting the system's data intake and analytical capabilities. In Round 1, participants take on the role of data engineers responsible for restoring the foundation of the system. The round consists of two interconnected phases. Participants must first recover and restore the corrupted dataset before using the recovered data to uncover deeper analytical insights.

Round 1(Phase 1):

In this phase, Participants work with Dataset 1, a deliberately corrupted social-media-like dataset. Teams must restore the intake pipeline by cleaning the data, handling missing values, identifying anomalies, and performing exploratory analysis.

Important Note:

The corrupted dataset will not be given directly. Participants must figure it out from the corrupted website (<https://datavortex-social-engine.vercel.app/>).

Hints for Round 1 (Phase 1):

- The system may not reveal everything at first glance.
- Look closely at the recovery logs and pay attention to what appears at the beginning of each line.
- Sometimes, the system leaves behind a message hidden in plain sight.
- Follow the pattern. Decode the connection. Find the node.
- Starting date: Day 1(13th September 2026)
- Deadline: Day 2 (14th September 2026, 11:59 PM)
- Submission Format: A Google Form link will be shared for submission.

Sections to Include:

- Cleaned Dataset (CSV/JSON)
- Exploratory Data Analysis (EDA) report
- Code Notebook (GitHub Repository)
 - Cleaning Code
 - Documentation
 - Reproducible Workflow

Guidelines:

- Any programming language or tool may be used.
- All transformations must be justified.
- Code must be properly documented.
- Teams must clearly explain assumptions made during cleaning.
- Fabrication of data is prohibited.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Data Cleaning Accuracy
- Data Handling & Preprocessing Logic
- EDA Depth & Insight Discovery
- Data Consistency & Standardisation
- Code Quality & Documentation
- Insight Interpretation & Clarity

Round 1(Phase 2):

Task: Once the intake pipeline is restored, participants must rebuild the Social Engine's analytical core. Teams must convert the cleaned dataset into SQL tables and solve a series of analytical SQL reasoning challenges involving trend detection, anomaly discovery, behavioural grouping, and correlation analysis.

- **Starting date:** Day 2 (14 th September 2026)
- **Deadline:** Day 3 (15 September 2026, 11:59 PM)
- **Submission Format:** A PDF document. A Google Form link will be shared for submission.

Sections to Include:

- SQL Queries
- Output Screenshots
- Logic Explanation
- Phase 2 Insight Report(PDF)

Guidelines:

- Any SQL tool is allowed.
- Schema design must be explained.
- Query logic should be clearly documented.
- Participants may use CTEs, Window Functions, Views, Procedures, etc.
- Hardcoded outputs will lead to disqualification.

Evaluation Criteria:

- SQL Query Correctness
- Schema Design & Table Structuring
- Analytical Reasoning & Problem solving
- Insight Quality
- Explanation of logic & Documentation

Outcome:

- Submissions will be evaluated by a panel of judges. Shortlisted teams will advance to Round 2.

General Rules:

- Team size must be between 1- 2 participants.
- All submissions must be original.
- Plagiarism will result in immediate disqualification.
- Late submissions will not be accepted.
- Teams must maintain their GitHub repositories throughout the competition.
- Any attempt to manipulate evaluation results will result in immediate disqualification.
- The organising committee reserves the right to verify code, outputs, and methodologies.
- The organising team reserves the right to modify timelines under exceptional circumstances.
- All decisions made by the judging panel shall be final.